Up 'n Roll: Metrics for Seeding Athletes

Prepared for Suketu Bhuva

First, separate two things

Hard limits decide who can fight whom. These are fairness rules, not skill metrics:

- Gender
- Belt division (white, or blue/purple)
- Weight (within a set kg limit)
- Age band

Seeding metrics decide who is better, so the system knows who to keep apart. Use these only inside the hard limits.

Metrics to use for seeding

1. **Your own results on Up 'n Roll (highest weight, about 40-50%).** Wins, finishes (submissions), and the strength of opponents beaten. Beating a strong athlete counts more than beating a weak one. This is the metric you can trust most, because you recorded it yourself.
2. **Belt and time at that belt (about 15-20%).** A blue belt of 3 years is usually stronger than one of 6 months. Purple is above blue.
3. **Competition experience (about 15%).** Number of matches fought, and results at other events, if verified.
4. **Years of training (about 10%).** Useful, but a weak signal on its own. Someone can train 5 years casually.
5. **Recent form (about 10%).** Last 2-3 matches, so a rising athlete or a returning injured one is judged fairly.
6. **Coach or academy rating (optional, small).** A simple 1-5 score, used only for new athletes with no record.

How to score it

Give every athlete a single number out of 100 using the weights above, then sort from highest to lowest. #1 and #2 go in opposite halves of the bracket, #3 and #4 in opposite quarters, and so on.

Example

Ravi has strong results, a purple belt and 5 years of training, so he scores 82. Aman has fewer matches but a good recent run, so he scores 78. Both are at the top, so the system puts them on opposite sides.

Things to be careful about

- **New athletes have no history.** Their score will rely on self-reported data (belt, years trained). Start them in the middle and let their first matches adjust the score quickly.
- **Do not trust self-reported data.** Verify belts and experience with coaches. Wrong inputs produce wrong seeding.
- **Keep it simple.** Five or six metrics are enough. More makes the formula hard to explain, and athletes will not trust something they cannot understand.
- **Show the reasons.** Let athletes see their score and what drove it.
- **Later, upgrade to a rating system.** Once you have enough matches (after a few events), switch the results part to an Elo-style rating, which updates automatically after every match and accounts for opponent strength.